

Maria Lopez - Disability Denial Example

Demo note

This example was created for a hackathon demo. It mirrors the same Maria Lopez information already saved in Elastic for the live agent run.

Who this is about

Name: Maria Lopez

Condition: Fibromyalgia

Where she is in the process: Second review after a denial

Main problem: Social Security said the records do not prove how her condition affects her ability to work every day.

What the agent should do

1. Read the denial letter.
2. Search Maria's doctor records.
3. Check Social Security rules.
4. Find missing proof.
5. Draft a doctor records request for a human helper to review.

Denial Letter Summary

Date: March 18, 2024

Decision: Denied

The denial says Maria's fibromyalgia is documented, but the file does not show enough proof of severity and work limits. The decision says the available records do not clearly explain how long Maria can sit, stand, walk, lift, focus, or keep a regular schedule.

The denial also notes that the file is missing recent follow-up notes from Lakeview Rheumatology and does not include a treating doctor's statement about Maria's work limits.

Plain-English issue

Maria is not being denied because fibromyalgia is impossible to prove.

She is being denied because the documents do not yet connect her symptoms to specific work limits in a way Social Security can review.

Doctor Records

Lakeview Rheumatology - January 12, 2024

Maria reports widespread pain, poor sleep, fatigue, and brain fog. Exam notes show widespread tenderness. The doctor continued medication and asked Maria to return in four weeks.

Lakeview Rheumatology - Missing follow-up records

The file mentions follow-up visits in February, March, and April 2024, but those notes are not included in the documents available for review.

Primary Care Note - February 2, 2024

Maria reports that pain and fatigue make it hard to sit at a desk for a full workday. The note does not estimate how long she can sit, stand, walk, lift, or stay focused.

What is missing

The file does not include a doctor statement that describes Maria's daily work limits in concrete terms.

Maria's Daily Work Limits

Maria says she can sit for about 20 minutes before needing to change position. She says she can stand for about 10 minutes before pain increases. She says she has several bad days each month where fatigue and pain keep her from leaving home.

Maria also reports trouble focusing when pain and sleep loss are severe. The documents describe limits with sitting, typing, focus, and keeping a regular schedule.

Possible missing proof

1. Treating doctor statement about sitting, standing, lifting, focus, and absences.
2. February through April rheumatology notes.
3. Medication side effect notes.
4. Any record explaining bad days and missed-work risk.

Helper Contact

Name: Elena Vargas

Role: Disability benefits helper

Email: elena.vargas@example.org

What the agent can draft

The agent can prepare a doctor records request asking Lakeview Rheumatology for missing follow-up notes and a doctor statement about Maria's work limits.

Human review required

The agent should not send anything by itself. A human should review the draft before it is sent to a doctor, helper, or agency.

Elastic note

This PDF is for the judge to read. The same text is already saved in Elastic so the agent can search it during the live demo.